



Automotive Mechanic

automotive-mechanic • 6 mo-2 yr program / apprenticeship

\$40K-\$65K / yr

THE TRADE

Diagnose and repair vehicles with a mix of hands-on skill and modern diagnostics. Entry is fast — helper or tech-school programs in 6 months to 2 years — and ASE credentials plus shop ownership keep the earning ceiling open.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$40K-\$65K

Site band (trades page / quiz) • 6 mo-2 yr programs • no dedicated salary post yet — assumed

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

ASE certifications (Engine Repair, Brakes, Electrical)

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit
- ☐ Call all local shops about helper work
- ☐ Earn OSHA 10 or shop-safety basics
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Buy a starter socket set + torque wrench
- ☐ Change oil and brakes on a friend's car
- ☐ Tour 2-3 shops; ask how they hire
- ☐ Start an ASE-Area study plan
- ☐ Apply to tech school or apprenticeship
- ☐ Apply to 2 dealership service programs
- ☐ Keep a repair log with photos
- ☐ Shadow a master tech for a day

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>